

SC's revised order on stray dogs opens up space for long-term solutions

If the **furore** following the Supreme Court's August 11 **order**, which **directed** that all stray dogs in Delhi-NCR be removed to shelters, **showed** a **deep polarisation** of **attitudes**, then its **modification** of the order on Friday **is** an opportunity to tackle a serious issue in a more **thoughtful**, scientific manner. The three-judge **bench**, to which the matter was reassigned after the original order was **reserved**, **strikes a balance** between **established** animal welfare laws and public safety concerns: Among other **directions**, the Court has said that while **sterilised** and vaccinated dogs are to be released where they were picked up from, the ones that have rabies or are **suspected** to have it, or display aggressive behaviour, are to remain in the shelters. The new order opens up space for **tempers** to **calm down**, so that a **sustainable** and **humane solution** to a **stubborn** problem **may** be found.

What this requires, in the first place, **is** an **acknowledgement** of, and **introspection** over, the reasons for the failure of the Animal Birth Control (Dog) Rules. Both a **paucity** of resources and a lack of **will** on the part of local governance have **hobbled** efforts to manage the stray dog population. In its order on Friday, the Court asked municipal authorities to give a full picture of the resources available, including the number of pounds, veterinarians, dog-catching personnel and cages/vehicles required for **compliance** with the ABC Rules. With the Court now expanding the scope of the matter to include all states and Union Territories, these hard numbers can help **plug holes** and be used to **formulate** a more realistic solution. They can help local bodies in other parts of the country, especially those that may not have the kind of resources that Delhi-NCR does, to form a clearer idea of the challenges, and develop a more targeted approach. Numbers can also help make a stronger case for why the vast community of those who care for "**streeties**" must be included if there is to be a **lasting** solution: Their help can be **sought**, for example, in ensuring that each dog in a locality is kept up-to-date with vaccinations, including for rabies – something that may be beyond the capacity of resource-poor municipal bodies.

That the problem of stray dogs **is** deeply linked to unmanaged solid waste cannot be ignored; like so many other species, such as pigeons, crows and cats, dogs too have come to depend on overflowing **rubbish bins** and garbage **dumps** for food. **Tackling** the trash problem **can go a long way** towards controlling the stray dog population. **In addition to** correcting other past mistakes, municipal authorities should not delay **addressing** this problem. **[Practice Exercise]**

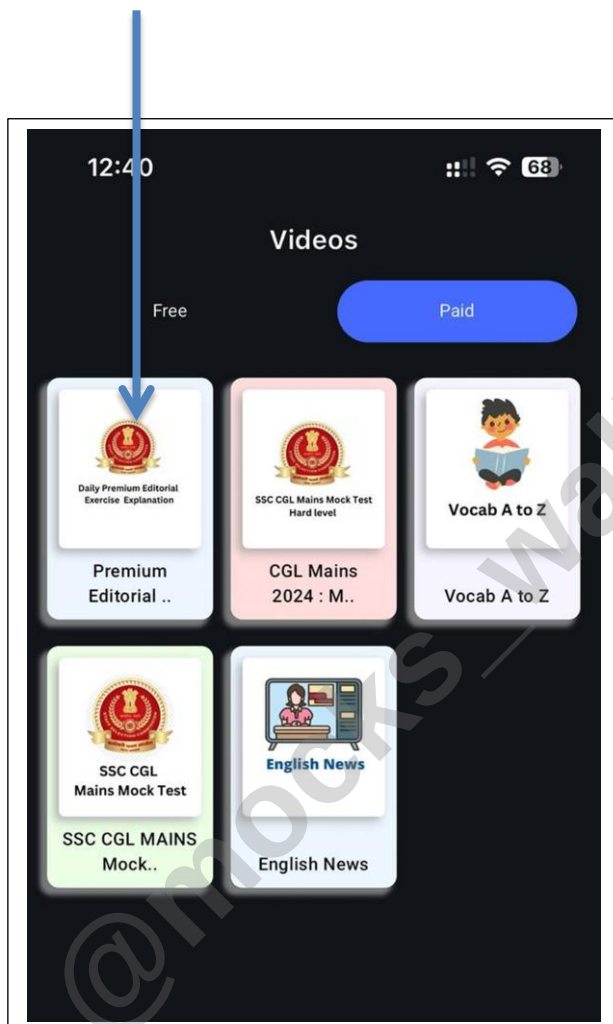
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Open up** (phrasal verb) – create, enable, widen, clear the way, make room रास्ता खोलना
2. **Furore** (noun) – uproar, outcry, commotion, brouhaha, furor कोलाहल
3. **Following** (preposition) – after, subsequent to, in the wake of, pursuant to, post के बाद
4. **Direct** (verb) – order, instruct, mandate, enjoin, decree आदेश देना
5. **Deep** (adjective) – profound, intense, acute, entrenched, severe गहरा
6. **Polarisation** (noun) – division, split, bifurcation, hardening of positions, partisanship ध्रुवीकरण
7. **Attitude** (noun) – stance, outlook, view, disposition, mindset रवैया
8. **Modification** (noun) – change, alteration, revision, amendment, adjustment संशोधन
9. **Thoughtful** (adjective) – considered, judicious, measured, reflective, prudent विवेकपूर्ण
10. **Bench** (noun) – a judge or magistrate presiding over a particular case. पीठ
11. **Reserve** (verb) – retain or hold (a right or entitlement), especially by formal or legal stipulation सुरक्षित रखना
12. **Strike a balance** (phrase) – find middle ground, reconcile, harmonise, calibrate, balance out संतुलन साधना
13. **Establish** (verb) – set up, institute, found, constitute, enact स्थापित करना
14. **Direction** (noun) – instruction, order, directive, mandate, guideline निर्देश
15. **Sterilise** (verb) – neuter, spay, castrate, desex, make infertile नसबंदी करना
16. **Suspect** (verb) – presume, believe, suppose, deem likely, consider संदेह करना
17. **Temper** (noun) – anger, ire, rage, agitation, mood क्रोध
18. **Calm down** (phrasal verb) – cool off, settle, de-escalate, ease, pacify शांत होना
19. **Sustainable** (adjective) – durable, viable, long-term, enduring, maintainable टिकाऊ
20. **Humane** (adjective) – compassionate, kind, merciful, benevolent, considerate मानवीय
21. **Stubborn** (adjective) – obstinate, intractable, persistent, tenacious, hard-to-solve जिद्दी
22. **Acknowledgement** (noun) – admission, recognition, acceptance, concession, note स्वीकारोक्ति

23. **Introspection** (noun) – self-examination, reflection, soul-searching, self-scrutiny, self-audit आत्ममंथन
24. **Paucity** (noun) – shortage, scarcity, dearth, insufficiency, lack कमी
25. **Will** (noun) – resolve, intent, determination, willingness, political will इच्छाशक्ति
26. **Hobble** (verb) – hinder, hamper, impede, cripple, bog down लड़खड़ाना
27. **Compliance** (noun) – adherence, conformity, observance, obedience, implementation अनुपालन
28. **Plug holes** (phrase) – fill gaps, close loopholes, patch up, fix lacunae, remedy deficiencies कमियाँ को कम करना
29. **Formulate** (verb) – devise, frame, craft, draw up, design तैयार करना
30. **Streeties** (noun) – strays, community dogs, street dogs, free-roaming dogs, indie dogs आवारा कुत्ते
31. **Lasting** (adjective) – enduring, durable, persistent, long-lasting, abiding स्थायी
32. **Seek** (verb) – request, solicit, ask for, enlist, call upon माँगना
33. **Rubbish bin** (noun) – dustbin, trash bin, garbage can, refuse container, wastebasket कूड़ेदान
34. **Dump** (noun) – landfill, garbage heap, refuse dump, tip, dumping ground कूड़ा-ढेर
35. **Go a long way** (phrase) – greatly help, make a big difference, contribute significantly, be very effective, advance the cause काफी मदद करना
36. **In addition to** (phrase) – besides, apart from, along with, as well as, over and above के अतिरिक्त
37. **Address** (verb) – tackle, deal with, attend to, remedy, confront सुलझाना

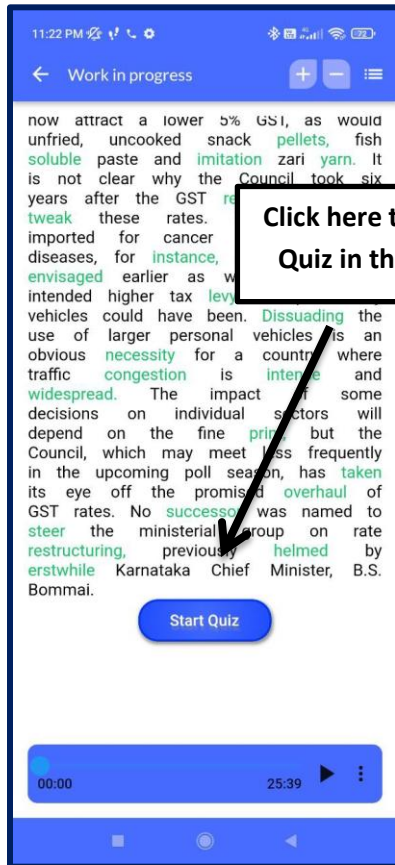
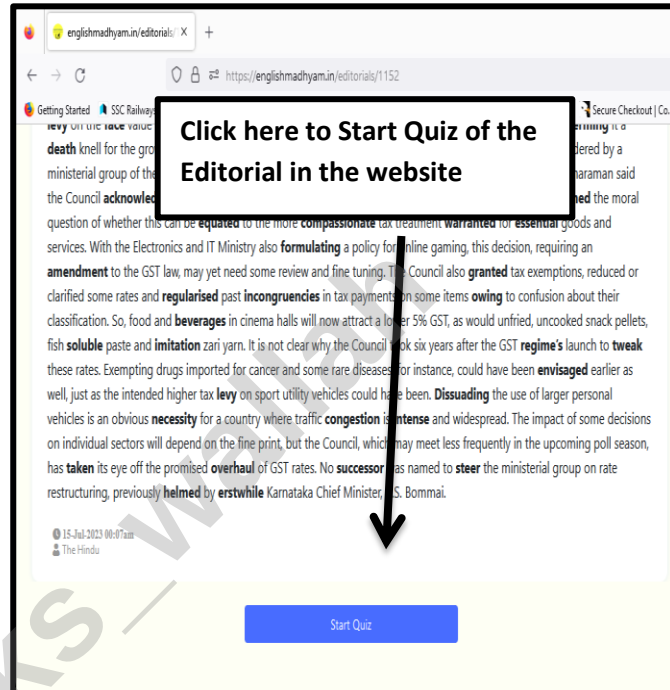
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Summary of the Editorial

1. **Original Order Sparks Outcry** – The SC's August 11 directive to remove all stray dogs in Delhi-NCR to shelters triggered widespread controversy and polarisation.
2. **Revised Order Brings Balance** – The new three-judge bench modified the earlier order, balancing **animal welfare laws** with **public safety concerns**.
3. **Sterilised Dogs Released** – Sterilised and vaccinated stray dogs are to be released back to the locations they were picked up from.
4. **Rabid or Aggressive Dogs Confined** – Dogs with rabies, suspected cases, or those showing aggressive behaviour are to remain in shelters.
5. **Space for Calm Dialogue** – The modified order lowers tensions and allows for a more **humane, scientific discussion** of solutions.
6. **ABC Rules Under Scrutiny** – The Court highlights the failure of **Animal Birth Control (Dog) Rules** due to poor implementation.
7. **Resource Gaps Identified** – Lack of funds, veterinarians, dog-catchers, shelters, and vehicles hampers population control efforts.
8. **Court Seeks Detailed Data** – Municipal authorities must provide hard numbers on facilities and resources to comply with ABC Rules.
9. **National Scope Expanded** – The SC has widened the case to include **all states and Union Territories**, not just Delhi-NCR.
10. **Data for Realistic Planning** – Accurate numbers can guide better planning and **targeted approaches** across India.
11. **Role of Local Communities** – "Streetie" caregivers should be involved in vaccination and care, as municipal bodies often lack capacity.
12. **Vaccination as Key Strategy** – Community help is vital in ensuring **universal rabies vaccination** for stray dogs.
13. **Waste Management Link** – The stray dog problem is tied to **unmanaged solid waste**, which provides an easy food source.
14. **Fixing Garbage Systems** – Controlling overflowing bins and dumps will reduce stray dog dependence and help manage populations.
15. **Long-Term Humane Solutions** – A mix of **better resources, community participation, strict waste management, and vaccination drives** is needed for sustainable outcomes.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based

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